

COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

A community development course equips practitioners with skills to plan, implement, and evaluate community initiatives, focusing on empowerment, social justice, and sustainable, participatory approaches. Key topics include needs assessment, project management, resource mobilization, and leadership, preparing students and participants for roles in NGOs, government agencies, and community based organizations.

Core Module Topics

- **Introduction to Community Development**
 - Concepts, principles, and history of community empowerment and change
- **Community Needs Assessment and Mapping**
 - Identification of community needs, situational analysis, and participatory rural appraisal techniques.
- **Project Planning and Management**
 - Design, implementation, and management of development projects, including project life cycle, Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E)
- **Participatory Approaches**
 - Strategies for ensuring community engagement, ownership, and stakeholder mobilization.
- **Resource Mobilization and Fundraising**
 - Techniques for securing resources for community initiatives, including grant writing and community fundraising
- **Leadership and Conflict Management**
 - Developing leadership skills, community group formation, and managing conflict within groups.

- **Cross-cutting Issues**

- Inclusion of gender equality, human rights, environmental sustainability, and health education in development

Course Structure Highlights

- **Foundation Units:** Sociology, Economics, and African Social Structures.
- **Skills Units:** Report writing, advocacy, communication skills, and data analysis
- **Specialized Areas:** Disaster management, microfinance, urban/Rural development, and Policy Advocacy

Targeted Skills

Graduates gain proficiency in social research, community mobilization, advocacy, and strategic planning, making them effective leaders in enhancing community welfare.